



IIT Madras
B.S. Degree

PRESENTATION SKILLS



*Strategies for
Professional Growth*

WEEK

3



PRATHAP HARIDOSS
PROFESSOR, IIT MADRAS



Communication in a professional setting

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Outline:

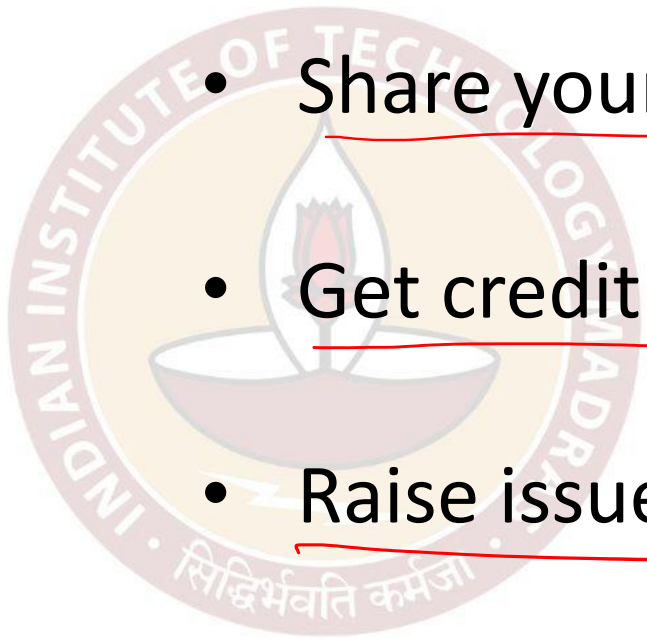
- 1) Why communicate at all?
- 2) Whom to communicate to, and whom not to communicate to?
- 3) Tone of communication
- 4) Length of communication
- 5) Sending emails
- 6) Communicating with your manager
- 7) Communicating with the team you lead
- 8) Communicating with a customer

What to do and what not to do!



Why communicate at all?

- Share your input ←
- Get credit for your work
- Raise issues
- Provide feedback



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Whom to communicate to, and whom not to communicate to?

You have joined the World leader in Tyres
“Wheelderness”

Your office chair has a wheel that needs to be replaced.

Whom should you contact?

Tone of communication

Polite please!!

“We do not provide accommodation. See the local newspapers for vacancies”



“We regret that we are unable to provide accommodation to you. However, we will share a few relevant contacts with you. Please get in touch with them to make suitable arrangements”



Tone of communication

Polite please!!

“What do you mean by “if found in order”? Don’t you know how to write in simple language?”



“I was unable to understand the message. I request you to please clarify what needs to be done”



Length of communication

Aim for efficient communication



“As we all know, education forms one of the pillars of success. I have been focussed on accumulating a good quality education. Good quality education requires involvement and sound decision making in selecting courses. I therefore deeply evaluate each course before deciding its applicability for my future career goals. In addition, since I am also involved in an electric car project, this has required me to travel for a contest. The last date for the registration was in the middle of the contest and I missed it for no fault of mine. The institute needs to have a flexible policy to address such genuine requirements. Taking into account my interests and exceptional circumstances, register me for the course now.”

“I need to register for the course, but missed the last date due to an official activity at the same time. I request you to let me know the procedure for late registration”



Sending emails

Carefully decide the list of recipients

Send the message to every higher authority whose email id I can find



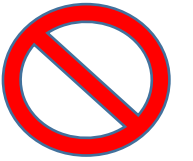
I will take the time and effort to figure out who is the appropriate person for this, and send the message only to them.



Sending emails

Formal emails are not social media messages

Use emojis and abbreviations liberally



Write complete sentences and convey ideas without scope for misunderstanding



Sending emails

Formal emails need to be well structure

Where can I get Library card?



Dear Sir/Madam,

I am new to campus and am unable to access the library. Please let me know the procedure to get a library card.

Regards,

Name and Roll number



Communicating with your manager

Formal emails should stay formal

Fill with personal comments about people



Give clear reports of work done and projections of what to expect coming up



Communicating with the team you lead

Formal emails should stay formal

Fiery messages get people to work better



Set clear expectations and deadlines



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Communicating with a customer

Be the service you would like to see

Argue with the customer, since it is important to win arguments

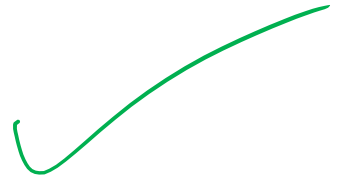


Be clear on what you can do for the customer and do so politely. Be careful what you write, since you are representing an organization

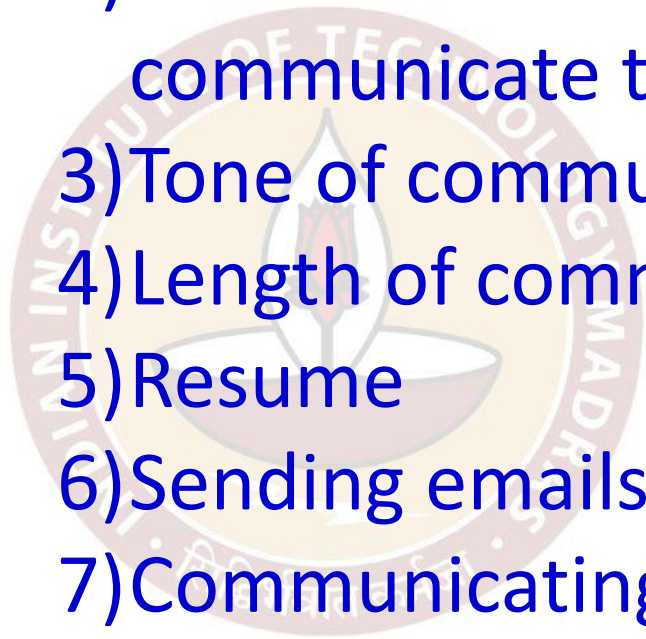


Summary

- Communication is both about the message as well as about you
- Your organization is impacted by your communication
- Your career is impacted by your communication //



- 1) Why communicate at all?
- 2) Whom to communicate to, and whom not to communicate to?
- 3) Tone of communication
- 4) Length of communication
- 5) Resume
- 6) Sending emails
- 7) Communicating to your manager
- 8) Communicating with the team you lead
- 9) Communicating with a customer
- 10) Project reports



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